

Jainism — MCQ Questions

Deterministic randomization seed: 8560500507743229150.

Coverage derivation: 16 examinable dimensions × 2 probes (core discrimination + trap/application) = 32 questions. The dimensions are textual identity; real/change; substance-quality-mode; six substances; soul; matter; epistemic classification; five knowledges; anekāntavāda; nayavāda; syādvāda; saptabhaṅgī; objections; material karma; bondage mechanics; liberation/ethics.

Attempt all questions before opening the solutions.

MCQ 1. The systematic anchor of Jaina philosophy

With reference to the Tattvārthasūtra, consider the following statements.

1. It is ascribed to Umāsvāti in Śvetāmbara usage and to Umāsvāmī in Digambara usage.
2. Its authority is confined to one of the two major traditions, which is why sectarian canons differ.
3. It states the path to liberation through right vision, right knowledge and right conduct together.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1, 2 and 3
- B. 1 and 3 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1 and 2 only

MCQ 2. What the title-words of the tradition actually mean

In Jaina usage, the terms jina and tīrthaṅkara respectively designate

- A. one who has conquered the passions and karmic bondage, and a liberated teacher who re-establishes the crossing over rebirth
- B. the first teacher of the present cycle alone, and any monk who has completed the five great vows under supervision
- C. the creator of the ordered cosmos, and the divine agent who allots merit and demerit to embodied beings at each rebirth
- D. a soul that has suppressed delusion temporarily, and a householder who has taken the lesser vows before ordination

MCQ 3. The definition of the real

In the Jaina formula utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya-yuktaṃ sat, the real is characterised by

- A. origination alone, since a thing is nothing more than the series of its successive productions
- B. origination, decay and persistence taken together, in one and the same real
- C. persistence alone, since change belongs only to appearance and never to the substance itself
- D. decay alone, since every determinate thing is defined by the moment at which it ceases

MCQ 4. Substance, quality and mode

Which statement correctly states the relation among substance (dravya), quality (guṇa) and mode (paryāya)?

- A. Substance is an inference from modes alone, since qualities are conventional descriptions with no bearer
- B. Quality and mode are two names for the same changing state, distinguished only by the standpoint of the observer
- C. Quality is the abiding characteristic of a persisting substance, while mode is the changing state in which it appears
- D. Mode is the abiding characteristic of a substance, while quality is the momentary state it currently exhibits

MCQ 5. Substances and extended substances

Which one of the following is a real substance (dravya) in mainstream Jaina exposition but not an extended substance (astikāya)?

- A. Time (kāla)
- B. Medium of rest (adharmā)
- C. Matter (pudgala)
- D. Space (ākāśa)

MCQ 6. Two substances with misleading names

In Jaina ontology, dharma-dravya and adharma-dravya respectively signify

- A. the medium that makes motion possible and the medium that makes rest possible for souls and matter
- B. accumulated merit and accumulated demerit, which jointly determine the quality of the next embodiment
- C. right conduct and wrong conduct, understood as the two moral orientations available to an embodied soul
- D. the ordering principle of the cosmos and the disordering principle that produces decay within it

MCQ 7. The Jaina conception of the soul

Which statement best expresses the Jaina conception of the soul (jīva)?

- A. It is one universal consciousness that appears as many only through the beginningless operation of ignorance
- B. It is a stream of momentary cognitions with no bearer, so that personal identity is a useful conventional fiction
- C. It is an eternal substance that becomes conscious only when the internal organ is conjoined with it in embodiment
- D. It is one of innumerable distinct substances, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power

MCQ 8. What is distinctive about matter

Which feature uniquely marks matter (pudgala) among the six substances?

- A. It alone possesses form, that is colour, taste, smell and touch, and is therefore sense-perceptible
- B. It alone undergoes origination and decay, the remaining substances being exempt from modal change
- C. It alone lacks space-points, which is why it can be divided indefinitely without any residue remaining

D. It alone is co-extensive with world-space and therefore accommodates every other substance within it

MCQ 9. Ordinary perception in the strict Jaina classification

In the strict Jaina epistemological classification, ordinary sensory cognition is

- A. a species of scriptural knowledge, since every perceptual judgement is already structured by inherited verbal categories
- B. only conventional direct knowledge, and strictly belongs with mediated cognition because it depends on sense and mind
- C. invalid cognition, because the senses are themselves products of karmic matter and therefore systematically deceive
- D. direct knowledge in the fullest sense, since sense-contact provides the clearest access available to an embodied knower

MCQ 10. Classifying the five kinds of knowledge

Which pair is correctly classified as indirect (parokṣa) in the basic fivefold scheme of knowledge?

- A. Sense-and-mind cognition and clairvoyant knowledge
- B. Sense-and-mind cognition and verbal or scriptural knowledge
- C. Knowledge of others' mental modes and omniscience
- D. Clairvoyant knowledge and knowledge of others' mental modes

MCQ 11. The order of the five kinds of knowledge

Which sequence correctly states the five kinds of Jaina knowledge in ascending order?

- A. Avadhi, manaḥparyāya, mati, śruta, kevala
- B. Śruta, mati, avadhi, kevala, manaḥparyāya
- C. Mati, śruta, avadhi, manaḥparyāya, kevala
- D. Mati, avadhi, śruta, manaḥparyāya, kevala

MCQ 12. Jaina causation

The Jaina account of causation is best described as

- A. dependent origination without any substrate, since causal regularity is all that causal talk records
- B. both-existence-and-non-existence of the effect, since the effect pre-exists as substance and is new as mode
- C. fresh production of the effect without qualification, since the effect is entirely absent before its production
- D. pre-existence of the effect without qualification, since nothing genuinely new can ever be produced

MCQ 13. What many-sidedness asserts

The doctrine of many-sidedness (anekāntavāda) primarily asserts that

- A. reality is unknowable in itself, so that every description reports only the classificatory habits of the describer

- B. contradictory properties genuinely belong to one thing at one time and in one and the same respect
- C. all judgements are equally true, since standpoints cannot be ranked and disagreement is therefore merely apparent
- D. the real object possesses innumerable aspects, so no single unqualified proposition exhausts it

MCQ 14. Three doctrines, three levels

Which formulation correctly distinguishes the three doctrines?

- A. Many-sidedness is logical, standpoint theory is ethical, and conditional predication is the metaphysical basis of the other two
- B. Many-sidedness and conditional predication are identical, while standpoint theory is a later scholastic elaboration of both
- C. Many-sidedness is metaphysical, standpoint theory is epistemic, and conditional predication is the logical-linguistic form of assertion
- D. Standpoint theory is metaphysical, conditional predication is epistemic, and many-sidedness is a rule of monastic debate

MCQ 15. The first of the seven standpoints

Which one of the following is the first member of the classical list of seven standpoints (naya)?

- A. Saṃgraha naya, the generic standpoint attending to shared class-character
- B. Evambhūta naya, the standpoint on which a term applies only during actual function
- C. Ṛjusūtra naya, the standpoint restricted to the thing in its present state
- D. Naigama naya, the mixed practical or purposive standpoint

MCQ 16. Matching a standpoint with its emphasis

Which pairing of a standpoint with its characteristic emphasis is correct?

- A. Evambhūta naya — the term applies only while the named function is being performed
- B. Vyavahāra naya — the etymological differentiation of synonymous words
- C. Śabda naya — the class-character shared by every member of a kind
- D. Saṃgraha naya — the thing considered strictly as it is at the present moment

MCQ 17. What the particle syāt contributes

In the doctrine of conditional predication, the particle syāt is best rendered as

- A. "probably", marking that the assertion is likely but not certain on the evidence available to the speaker
- B. "apparently", marking that the assertion holds for appearances although the thing in itself is unknown
- C. "let it be granted", marking a provisional concession made only for the purposes of a formal debate
- D. "in a certain respect", marking a definite assertion restricted by substance, place, time and mode

MCQ 18. The fourth of the seven predications

In the sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī), the fourth member is

- A. syād asti ca nāsti ca, in some respect it is and it is not
- B. syān nāsti, in some respect it is not
- C. syād avaktavyam, in some respect it is inexpressible
- D. syād asti ca avaktavyam, in some respect it is and is inexpressible

MCQ 19. The meaning of inexpressibility

In the sevenfold predication, avaktavya chiefly signifies that

- A. the proposition takes a third truth-value lying between plain truth and plain falsity
- B. the object in question lies wholly beyond language and can be approached only in silence
- C. a single unqualified expression cannot convey affirmation and negation simultaneously
- D. the speaker suspends judgement because the available evidence is insufficient for assertion

MCQ 20. Why no contradiction arises

The Jaina claim that "in some respect the jar is and is not" escapes formal contradiction because

- A. the law of non-contradiction is denied outright, and Jaina logic replaces it with a rule of graded assertion
- B. one of the two predications is always merely conventional and is finally cancelled by the other
- C. affirmation is literal while negation is figurative, so the two predicates never occupy the same logical plane
- D. affirmation and negation are indexed to different substance, place, time or mode, so the respects differ

MCQ 21. The self-refutation objection

The standard self-refutation objection against many-sidedness argues that

- A. the doctrine presupposes a creator who guarantees that the many aspects of a thing form a coherent whole
- B. if every assertion must be qualified then the doctrine itself must be qualified, and it then loses universal force
- C. the doctrine cannot explain how a single soul is reborn while remaining numerically the same individual
- D. the seven predications are too few, since the number of aspects in a real thing is admittedly innumerable

MCQ 22. The 2022 absolutism charge

Which is the strongest Jaina reply to the claim that non-absolutism cannot be sustained without postulating absolutism?

- A. Non-absolutism is a purely practical maxim of debate and therefore makes no claim about reality that could be absolute
- B. Non-absolutism concerns only religious language, so the objection misapplies a logical test to a devotional context
- C. Non-absolutism denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers, while omniscience remains the internal case of complete knowledge

D. Non-absolutism is asserted absolutely, and the resulting exception is accepted as the necessary cost of any general theory

MCQ 23. What is distinctive about Jaina action-matter

Which statement best captures the Jaina conception of action and moral consequence (karma)?

- A. It is subtle matter that flows toward the soul and adheres to it, with passion determining the depth and duration of that adhesion
- B. It is a mental impression left by volition, so that continuity of character is secured without any enduring bearer
- C. It is an unseen quality residing in the self that produces its result at the appointed time without material mediation
- D. It is an unseen potency generated by ritual action alone, which links the act performed to the result eventually enjoyed

MCQ 24. Two forms of bondage

Which pair correctly distinguishes the two forms of bondage recognised by the Jainas?

- A. Psychic bondage is the soul's own passionate modification, while material bondage is the actual adhesion of karmic particles
- B. Psychic bondage is the intention behind an act, while material bondage is the external act as observed by others
- C. Psychic bondage is bondage to mental objects, while material bondage is bondage to physical objects such as wealth and body
- D. Psychic bondage occurs in ascetics who retain subtle pride, while material bondage occurs only in householders

MCQ 25. The five causes of bondage

Which set correctly gives the five causes of bondage recognised in Jaina soteriology?

- A. Ignorance, craving, clinging, becoming and birth
- B. Anger, pride, deceit, greed and delusion
- C. Influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding and liberation
- D. Wrong vision, non-restraint, carelessness, passions and activity

MCQ 26. What determines what in bondage

Which pairing of a bondage parameter with its principal determinant is correct?

- A. Duration is determined by activity, while type is determined by passion
- B. Intensity is determined by activity, while quantity is determined by passion
- C. Type is determined by wrong vision, while duration is determined by carelessness
- D. Type and quantity are determined by activity, while duration and intensity are determined by passion

MCQ 27. Destructive and non-destructive karmas

Which set contains only destructive (ghātiyā) karmas?

- A. Vedanīya, nāma, gotra and āyus

- B. Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, vedanīya and gotra
- C. Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohanīya and antarāya
- D. Mohanīya, antarāya, nāma and āyus

MCQ 28. Seven principles and nine categories

The nine categories (padārtha) of Jaina exposition consist of

- A. the six substances together with influx, bondage and liberation, which complete the cosmology
- B. the seven principles together with substance and mode, which supply the ontological framework
- C. the seven principles together with merit and demerit, which make moral valence explicit
- D. the seven principles together with right knowledge and right conduct, which complete the path

MCQ 29. Stoppage and shedding

Which statement correctly distinguishes stoppage (saṃvara) and shedding (nirjarā)?

- A. Stoppage removes karma already bound, while shedding prevents new karma from being bound at all
- B. Stoppage blocks fresh influx of karmic matter, while shedding wears away karma already accumulated
- C. Stoppage belongs to householders and shedding to ascetics, the two being stages of a single vow
- D. Stoppage and shedding are alternative names for the same disciplinary process, differing only by tradition

MCQ 30. The eleventh stage of spiritual development

With reference to the fourteen stages, which statement is correct?

- A. The eleventh stage only suppresses delusion, so a soul reaching it by that ladder necessarily falls back
- B. The eleventh stage is the momentary activity-free condition immediately preceding the perfected state
- C. The eleventh stage marks the attainment of right vision for the first time and is the decisive breakthrough
- D. The eleventh stage destroys delusion permanently and therefore leads directly to the twelfth and thirteenth stages

MCQ 31. Omniscience while embodied

The condition described as sayoga-kevalī is best characterised as

- A. a soul that has suppressed all passions and awaits the fruition of its deluding karma before liberation
- B. an omniscient being still embodied and active, whose destructive karmas are destroyed while non-destructive karmas remain
- C. a perfected soul at the summit of the world, disembodied and free from every trace of karmic matter
- D. a householder who has taken the lesser vows and attained limited clairvoyant knowledge of material things

MCQ 32. Voluntary passionless death

Which statement about sallekhanā is doctrinally the safest to write in an examination?

- A. It is a meritorious act of self-destruction that may be undertaken by any practitioner who wishes to shorten a difficult life
- B. It is identical with suicide in every philosophically relevant respect, differing only in the vocabulary used to describe it
- C. It has been conclusively settled in Indian law as a protected religious practice, so its legal status raises no further question
- D. It is a gradual, supervised and passion-free relinquishment of food undertaken when death is already unavoidable or decline incurable